

Research Questions and Empirical Roadmap

Each question becomes one plain descriptive equation.

RQ1 APPEARANCE

Does CEO Q&A uncertainty rise before a cash acquisition is announced?

$$\text{Uncertainty} = \text{pre-announcement quarter}$$

Read: within-firm shift in the anticipation quarter, against the firm's own ordinary quarters.

RQ2 TIMING

Does uncertainty resolve at announcement while cash remains until completion?

$$\text{Uncertainty and cash} = \text{PRE1} + \text{GAP} + \text{POST}$$

Read: uncertainty should drop from PRE1 to GAP; cash should drop only after completion.

RQ3 PAYMENT METHOD

Is the pre-announcement run-up stronger for cash acquirers than stock acquirers?

$$\text{Uncertainty} = \text{cash pre-announcement} + \text{stock pre-announcement}$$

Read: test the cash-minus-stock difference directly, not just whether one side is significant.

COMMON DESIGN

Firm controls; firm and year-quarter fixed effects; firm-clustered errors.

All three empirical tests are descriptive within-firm comparisons; they do not identify causal effects.